MONTHLY UPDATE

Mauritius: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Cabinet approved Mauritius Vision 2050 on 11 September and agreed to introduce nine bills, among them a National Crime Agency Bill that requires judicial orders for interception of communications. The central bank launched a statistical data platform on 3 September. The first electronic bill of exchange under the amended Bills of Exchange Act was reported on 16 September.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Cabinet approved Mauritius Vision 2050 on 11 September, targeting a US$50bn economy with digital among seven strategic sectors; the document is not published.

Legislation and regulation

A third bill was set out in public rather than in print. The ICT minister said the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill would make the digital driving licence an official electronic version equivalent to the traditional one and let holders settle fixed traffic penalties at any court and, above all, online, putting the affected population at more than 800,000 licence holders and saying the licence depends on interconnecting transport services, law enforcement and public administration. The Bill text is not held and no enactment or commencement date is stated.

The 2025 law on electronic transferable records was used for the first time. A commercial bank took five electronic bills of exchange from a trading group, created in under 30 minutes and transferred in under an hour, under the Finance Act 2025 amendment that made Mauritius the first African jurisdiction to adopt the UNCITRAL model law on the subject. The ICT minister said on 29 September that the provisions for paying fines online take effect on 30 October 2026, for fines carrying no penalty points; the Bill's enactment is not on record. The ICT ministry and Meta are to discuss a framework agreement on online safety at working sessions on 6 and 7 October, covering moderation of content in Mauritian Creole, child protection, takedown requests and a possible requirement for local representation; nothing is signed. A law firm's reading has the amendment Act recognise electronic transferable records and contracts formed by automated message systems. The ICT ministry held its working session with Meta on faster content removal, Kreol moderation and proposed amendments to the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act, with no framework yet signed.

The government said bills and amendments on cybersecurity, cybercrime and the ICT Act are in preparation, and the minister described a framework agreement being negotiated with a platform operator on takedowns and verified identities. No text or date is published.

Data protection

Interception gained its first reform instrument since the 2025 parliamentary revelations. The National Crime Agency Bill published by the National Assembly would make interception of communications, real-time collection and traffic-data preservation by the new agency subject to Judge in Chambers orders. The Assembly stands adjourned to 20 October, and no judicial-authorisation requirement is in force.

Regional collaboration

Mauritius is one of 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration that Earth- and Universe-observation satellite data should be accessible to all under open licences, save justified exceptions, published on 10 September.

Standards

Mauritius moved to bind its own digital services to a standard. Cabinet took note on 28 August of a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service, from procurement through maintenance, and the government information service set out that the framework will cover every service developed, procured or maintained by the state. Noted is not issued: the record held carries no compliance date, no owner and no consequence for a service that fails it.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The regulator opened a call for applications for a mobile number portability licence; no launch date is given.

Data Storage

The central information systems division runs a central backup service for government.

Cybersecurity

Figures presented at a government workshop on 7 October put reported security incidents at 6,073 in 2025 against 5,221 in 2024, with cyberbullying up from 491 to 702 cases.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The digital driving licence was soft-launched on the KOREK app on 29 September, with legal effect from 1 January 2027; access needs a fully activated MauPass account, and promotion-agency staff are to help the 883,700 licence holders register from October. No count of licences activated is published. The ICT minister said a driver without a smartphone may go on showing the original physical licence after 1 January 2027, and put MauPass registrations at 500,000; the digital licence carries a QR code the police will use to check authenticity.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The environment ministry made online filing of Waste Carrier Licence applications through the Economic Development Board platform compulsory from October, for individuals, firms, parastatals, local authorities and ministries alike; an online submission does not itself authorise transport.

Cabinet noted that online applications for the State Age Pension opened on 7 October 2026, with a pension estimate tool on the KOREK! super-app and assisted applications at 38 Social Security Offices for people with limited digital literacy or access.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

The virtual reality programme in primary schools is the second digital programme now running in the primary estate, after the education platform launched in January under the operator pilot. Neither publishes a school count or a pupil reach. On an island of this size the rural indicators are answered by national programmes rather than by a rural one, and what the repository cannot say of either programme is how much of the estate it has reached.

Technology

AI

A junior finance minister announced the creation of an AI City to an international convention on 12 September. No site, investor, capacity or date accompanies the announcement.

ICT Industry

The month's industry news is a stake, not a product. A pan-African investment fund took a minority holding in a Mauritian digital transformation consultancy, with no sum disclosed. Neither the stake size, the use of proceeds nor a holding period is stated.

Data

National statistics

The central bank opened its own statistics rather than waiting for the statutory framework to be rewritten. It launched a central statistical database on 3 September, developed with the International Monetary Fund and the African Development Bank, opening statistical information to businesses, researchers, policymakers and citizens; the prime minister said a standards and codes report had underscored the need to strengthen statistical capacity and modernise dissemination, and that the statistics statute and the central bank statute are being reviewed. No series list, update cadence, licence or machine-readable access route is stated for the portal.

Open data

The central bank put its statistics on a standards-based platform. It launched its statistical data platform on 3 September, built with monetary fund and development bank support on an open data platform with standardised statistical data and metadata dissemination, and stated as the first African central bank on that platform's second version. No dataset count, series coverage, licence or machine-readable access statement accompanies the launch — which for a platform whose point is machine-readable dissemination is the thing a user would check first.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The incumbent operator and the cloud company held an executive workshop on cloud, data and artificial intelligence for more than 125 delegates of state-owned enterprises.

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